

KF5 Expanded Version of Teachings

Karis is an invitation to a relationship based on mutual generosity.

“Search me, O God, and know my heart. Examine me and know my thoughts. See if there is any way in me that causes pain, and lead me in the ways of eternity.” (Psalm 139:23–24)

0:01 OPENING

0:02 PRESENTING

0:06 KARIS CIRCULATION

0:07 GUIDELINES & LIMITATIONS

Let’s look at the first KF guideline, “We cooperate for the security and efficiency of the group.” Participating members cooperate to ensure a secure environment and an efficient experience for everyone by making a trustworthy effort to attend the entire meeting. By walking together through all the steps of the training, we lay the necessary foundation for the integration process and approach our healing as one entity.

I would like to remind you that we are a confidential fellowship. This means that we do not share what other members say in the meetings, nor do we share the playback numbers, the recordings, the meeting notes, or the KF self-help guides with people outside Karis Fellowships. If you leave the Fellowships, please let us know your decision and remember that “we respect the group by always announcing our presence”. It is not respectful or trustworthy to eavesdrop on meetings or listen to recordings if you are no longer participating in Karis Fellowships.

Only those who are in the Fellowships and have done the work to get this far, who have shown themselves to be people of intention and courage, are able to understand and use KF tools effectively. This is difficult work, and only those who are willing to do the work will succeed. So, like Mary, treasure in your heart what you learn, and help others work their way toward discovering their own potential by inviting them to join a book study.¹ Look for people who know that they need help. Are they already working on their personal development? Are they people you are willing to support? These are the key questions that we must ask ourselves before we invite anyone to the study. The journey begins with the book study where we find out if people can endure this process. We might discover that people will refuse to do the work but still expect results. We know from Dr. Horney’s book that the illusion of effortless health and well-being is neurotic.² Sharing KF tools with those outside the Fellowships will not substantially help them in the long run because they do not have KF support and training. Instead, let them see the development that is happening in you. Tell them what you are learning about yourself. If they show interest, invite them to join you on the journey, beginning with the NHG book study.

0:09 MINDFULNESS & MEDITATION TRAINING

Over the months, you will learn different forms of meditation that will help you reorient to God and to His Creation—a creation that includes your True Self. Many of us are familiar with the idea of practicing

the presence of God, but most of us have no idea what it means.³ We are not taught to live in the present moment with God, nor how to remain there. In KF, we learn to remain in God's presence through mindfulness training.

Mindfulness techniques teach us moment-by-moment awareness, posture, breathing, and non-judgment. We begin by simply noticing our bodies, and then we observe our emotions and thoughts. By being mindful, we can learn to stop manufacturing the feelings and experiences that we use to protect our pride. From a platform of non-judgment, we can observe what is actually there, within us and without. Only then are we able to change the direction of our lives.

You cannot authentically present yourself to the Great Physician to be healed until you acknowledge that you are sick.⁴ Mindfulness helps you recognize the subtle changes in your body that indicate soul sickness, or misorientation. If you learn to listen to your body, you will be able to recognize when you are heating up or melting down. You can then use your tools while you still have some self-control; you can deal with your hurt pride rather than punishing your True Self or others out of self-hate. When you are mindful, you are awake. You pay attention to what *is*, not to how it should be. Through mindfulness training, you learn how to be a mindful observer of what you are doing. Who you are and what you do are inextricably linked, so when you observe what you are doing, you find out who you are right now. When we are not mindful, we are forgetful. We forget about our bodies. We forget about the person who is speaking because we are focused on what we want to say. We forget to pay attention as we go about our activities. We forget that we are citizens in a material world, living in a community; we are egocentric, wasteful, and messy.

In our opening statement, we remind each other that we meet together to ground ourselves in reality. One of your goals in KF is to stop living in the Idol's illusions and accept what is real. Mindfulness tools help you recognize what is real—who you are and what you are actually doing right now. You can then enter the ring of reality and courageously come to grips with your self-hate. In the ring of reality, your eyes are opened to the real growth that is taking place within you—growth that produces lasting joy and self-confidence in all of life's circumstances.

Let's continue with the **3-Minute Breathing Space**.⁵ I will give you minimal guidance and let you explore your own experience. Take a mindfulness posture, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

The 3-Minute Breathing Space

AWARENESS

Take one minute to explore your present experience, in this present moment. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

GATHERING

Gather yourself around your breathing for one minute. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

EXPANDING

Take one minute to expand, noticing your entire body as it breathes. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

And pause. Remain in mindful awareness while I read another verse of our hymn, *Breathe on Me, Breath of God*.

Breathe on me, Breath of God,
Blend all my soul with Thine,

Until this earthly part of me
Glow with Thy fire divine.⁶

Take a deep breath.

This hymn was written in 1878 by Edwin Hatch, who served his community as a well-known scholar and Anglican priest.

(Go straight to the Karis Confession to allow time for a longer Toolbox)

0:20 KARIS CONFESSION

0:21 TOOLBOX

You may wonder why I wrote these notes for you instead of teaching you in a spontaneous manner. The KF Team is compiling a written guide for those who are on this journey. I will not always be with you, and by writing these notes I intend to leave a legacy that will guide you and others when I am gone.

KF Confession 1 goes like this:

We confess that we have worshipped and served an Idol Self that we have created.

In this Toolbox lesson, we will practice the second series of the **Tapping Protocol**.⁷ This entire intervention will then be available to help you stand and fight it out when you step into the ring with your fears. Before we begin tapping, however, let's look at a few points that will help you train to be a creature no longer driven by fear but able to respond in the moment with grace and truth.

1. Our only hope of recovery is in Jesus, who gives us the alternative to worshipping our fears

When we are born again, we are born as our True Self, and it is our business, in partnership with the Holy Spirit and other believers, to develop our True Self into its glorious potential in Christ. In KF, we believe that this is what the apostle Paul means when he tells us to *work out our salvation*.⁸ The main characteristic of this salvation is the Fruit of the Spirit, which Paul describes in his letter to the Galatians.⁹ This Fruit is produced by your True Self and is a demonstration of your true glory; it is the trustworthy evidence of your connection to Jesus. So, if your life is expressing love, joy, peace, and the other qualities that Paul lists, you know that you have that connection. I want to challenge you with this: if you are not producing the Fruit of the Spirit in your life on a regular and ongoing basis, your connection to the Spirit is faulty. Once you admit that your connection to the Spirit is faulty, you can start the process of rediscovering your True Self and glory.

2. Events reveal fear that is already there *(Repeat)*

During these last weeks, we have observed our fears and the events or trials that stir up those fears. Remember that when you feel like you need to force, rescue, or avoid something or someone, you are probably in fear. Last week, we began learning the **Tapping Protocol** to help us calm our bodies down when we fall into various trials. Tap regularly, even when you are not aware of tension building up. Start with smaller, daily issues and then work up to the bigger, compelling, addictive issues. Whenever you feel strain and are not in peace, tap.

One of the illusions of the Idol is the story that our fear and strong reactions are caused by the events around us. In reality, events do not cause or create fear; *they only expose the fear that is already there. (Repeat)* Fear motivates us to make destructive choices that ruin our connection with God and our True Self. Our fear-based choices also impoverish and harm the lives of those around us. Just as love is constructive, fear is destructive. We feel fear when our Idol's search for glory is threatened, but saving the life of our Idol Self will not free us from that fear; in fact, it perpetuates it.

3. Pray ahead and avoid the rush

When we pray ahead about our fears, we are preparing for the experiments, or various trials, that inevitably come into our lives. If you are praying our opening prayer from KF3—"Examine me, O God, and reveal my motivations. Run experiments on me and discover my fearful thoughts. See if there is any hurtful or idolatrous way in me, and lead me in the ways of eternity"—you can face your fear with courage and be confident that God is answering your prayer.¹⁰ He is giving you opportunities that will help you recognize the areas of your life where you need training, and, like a great coach, He is there with you to help you succeed. So, you can step boldly into the ring of reality, knowing that He wants you to succeed and that your trial is essential for your training. In all your life events, you might try saying this to yourself: *I am not afraid because I have prayed. (Repeat)* The Idol Self uses your personal power to fuel the fear that drives its search for glory, but when you choose to co-labor with God in your training, you can harness that power to produce the Fruit of the Spirit in your life and to access the many benefits of God's gifts.

If you have been training hard, the fight with your fear will be easier. Any athlete or musician knows that if you haven't practiced, you will not be able to perform. In the same way, if you have not been training hard, the fight will be beyond your range of skills, and you will find it impossible to fulfill your good intentions. When you fail to express the Fruit of the Spirit, you might recognize that you have not trained well enough or are simply not ready for that fight. Rather than judging yourself, consider the quality of your training and the timing of the trial. Do you need more tools? Is there someone who can help you? Do you simply need more time to grow? Other battles will surely come, so do yourself a favor—prepare now for your next battle.

Listen again to our quote from Robert Louis Stevenson:

You cannot run away from weakness; you must at some time fight it out or perish; and if that be so, why not now, and where you stand?¹¹

If you are in KF, you are learning to stop running away from your weaknesses. You are learning how to fight it out, where you stand. Your fight is not with others; it is with the Idol's pride and its efforts to save its own life. You can't take on every battle right now, but you can take on the battle that has been revealed to you today. Tapping is one way to fight it out.

Let's continue with the second series of the **Tapping Protocol**. Recall your healing statement from the last lesson. *(Pause)*

Second Series

Continue to breathe deeply as you follow my guidance.

- To begin, say your healing statement out loud. *(Pause for 5 seconds)*

- Now, using the three middle fingers of your right hand, gently tap on the back of your left hand between the tendons of your little finger and your ring finger. (Repeat) While you are tapping, breathe deeply and say your healing statement out loud one more time. (Pause for 5 seconds)

We are now going to do an eye movement exercise. Keep your head still and move only your eyes. Breathe deeply and continue to tap the back of your hand while you follow these directions:

- Focus your eyes straight ahead. (Pause for 3 seconds)
- Now close your eyes while you continue to tap and breathe. (Pause for 3 seconds)
- Open your eyes again and, without moving your head, look sharply down toward your right hip or elbow for a few seconds. (Pause for 3 seconds)
- Now look sharply down toward your left side, again without moving your head. (Pause for 3 seconds)
- Repeat this right and left eye movement two more times while you tap and breathe. (Pause for 5 seconds)
- Now roll your eyes in a circle, three times in one direction and then three times in the opposite direction. You might look to one side and then direct your eyes up the wall to the ceiling, across the ceiling, down the opposite wall, and across the floor. (Pause for 10 seconds)
- Continue to tap while you hum the tune “Happy Birthday”. (Pause for 5 seconds)
- Now quickly count out loud to fifteen. (Pause 5 seconds)
- Hum the tune again while you continue to tap. (Pause for 5 seconds)

Pause. Take a sip of purified water and relax. After the meeting, you can finish up your tap by repeating the first series, which we learned in the last lesson. Use the **Tapping Protocol** to take on your battle for today. To prepare for our next lesson, print out the **Two Paths Flowchart** and add it to your KF ring binder.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Coach and Father, help me stop running away from my weaknesses. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, “Does anyone have comments or questions about the Toolbox?”)

0:30 SHARING

1:00 BIBLE TEACHING

Let’s go back to our beautiful passage in the first chapter of James. This is my translation of **James 1:2–4**, with a little paraphrase.

²Guide yourselves into all joy, my siblings, when you fall into and are surrounded by all kinds of experiments, ³knowing that these experiments examine what you trust and act upon. They also grow your ability to remain under examination in future experiments, experiments that will further explore your ever-expanding potential. ⁴Give this growing ability of endurance a chance to accomplish its purpose, which is to make you a mature and complete person, lacking nothing, fully equipped for your joy and mission.

Take a deep breath.

My first point is often the most difficult to remember.

1. The struggle is the valuable part (*Repeat*)

If you learn one thing from this meeting, learn this: the struggle is the most important part of your process. Do not hesitate to get into the struggle because it is through well-managed struggling that you become strong. If you exercise at the gym or are learning a new skill, you already know this.

In his groundbreaking book, *The Road Less Traveled*, Scott Peck begins with a troubling but very true statement: *Life is difficult*.¹² (*Repeat*) In other words, life is a struggle. Our problem is that we do not know how to struggle productively. We can only think of struggle as an unfair or purposeless kind of suffering. One of our most discouraging struggles comes when we try to live loving lives but find ourselves driven by our compelling needs. In that struggle, we fear that our neurotic needs will go unmet. We also fear living with failure. Failure afflicts our pride system, and hurt pride adds to the burden of our struggle.

When the Idol anticipates failure, our neurotic pride system is threatened, and we find that the terror of our self-hate is stronger and much more compelling than our commitment to love. If you have not been training, your love will be too weak to stand against the compulsive need to protect your pride. Instead, you will sacrifice your True Self and others in order to meet that need, and this will create a further burden of self-hate and fear in your soul. You might think that the way to overcome the unloving reactions of your pride and self-hate is to simply exercise more self-control, but you already know from experience that your self-control is too weak and inconsistent to be reliable. The first step toward building a consistent, loving life is to get rid of your pride and, at the same time, learn to practice a gritty faith that stands against the Idol, fights it out, and trusts our Savior. As self-hate and the fear of hurt pride lose their grip, your struggles will become manageable and productive, and the love that God has already deposited in you will start to emerge.

James does not say that we have to suffer in our struggles. He teaches that we can learn to struggle without suffering. We can rejoice in the truth that the struggle produces endurance. Endurance is absolutely necessary for training, but, unfortunately, we don't care about that. We care about our comfort and our relief from tension. We want our own way. Our culture does not value endurance, and we have been trained to think that we have a right to quick results and instant gratification. If we are not whole, well, happy, content, fulfilled, strong, comfortable, and successful within a week or two, or an hour or two—and especially after we have done a KF worksheet—we think that there is something wrong and that life is unfair. The struggle teaches us to endure productively, doing what we can while trusting our Father and Coach.

2. The discovery and the fostering of our True Self require a lot of endurance

The ongoing discovery of your True Self begins with months of effort, but learning to dwell consistently in your True Self will take years of maintenance and care—in fact, it will take the rest of your life. Just like maintaining your physical health, maintaining your True Self requires commitment, courage, and a sustained effort in an oriented direction. To build anything worthwhile, you need to learn the art of endurance. When you practice endurance, you grow in courage, and with more courage you can endure tension longer and with more productive results. You are an eternally developing creature designed to keep growing, and growth happens when you endure.

Of course, our Idol Self is committed to effortless superiority and easy achievements. Whatever it imagines should happen should happen now, and when it doesn't happen, the Idol punishes us and others with self-hate. The Idol does not have the fortitude to tolerate set-backs, frustrations, or changes. Every frustration is a reminder that we, like everyone else, have limitations—limitations against which the Idol Self is constantly rebelling. What a waste of energy! We squander all that potential fighting real limitations when we could be learning to endure.

3. Let endurance do its work

What is endurance? The Greek word translated as *endurance* means to *remain under*. When you fall into an experiment, it is, as James says, an opportunity to see what skills you have, which areas of your life need work, and how your character is developing. If you can manage your self-hate, you get to see the truth about yourself, and if you can remain under the tension of your opportunity, you become creative—you explore, get help, and work on your connection to the Spirit. You discover how to live with less suffering, and you cause less suffering for others. Your compassion grows, and you experience more gratitude. You learn to lean more on God and less on your Idol Self.

4. Endurance trains us to be trustworthy

Finally, what is the goal of your endurance through all of these experiments? The goal is to grow you up—to unify and fully equip you so that you have everything you need to accomplish your mission. You have a vital mission; God's reputation and the reputation of the believing community are in your hands. God cannot afford to entrust His redemptive purposes to untrustworthy people, so if you want to co-labor with Him to accomplish your mission, you must endure training to become trustworthy.

You may have been taught that the purpose of endurance and suffering is to fulfill some abstract and mysterious plan, but James teaches that endurance is designed to help YOU fulfill YOUR mission and design. Endurance helps YOU become whole, complete, integrated, and true, so that YOU who are alive in Christ are no longer forced to live in fear, subject to addictive and compulsive reactions to life events. You may think that you lack this or that resource to help you accomplish your mission, but what do you really lack? You lack the health and orientation of the True Self—the self that circulates with God and with His Creation. If you focus your efforts on the restoration of your True Self and your orientation to God and His Creation, you will flourish and grow into your full potential, and you most certainly will lack nothing.

Our prayer might go something like this:

I need endurance training, Coach! (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the Bible teaching?")

1:10 INTEGRATION

Sip some purified water and prepare to take some notes. In this lesson I will give you minimal guidance. We will spend one minute on each step of the **FAITH Process**. Assume your mindfulness posture, and breathe. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

Here is our integration focus: *Consider what happens when you are faced with an opportunity to endure. (Repeat) (Pause for 30 seconds)*

The FAITH Process

Feelings

Recognize any feelings or numbness that you experience when you *consider what happens when you are faced with an opportunity to endure*. Observe and breathe. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

Awareness without judgment

Allow your experience to rest in your awareness as you *consider what happens when you are faced with an opportunity to endure*. Notice any conflicts or resistance. Give yourself permission to explore without judgment whatever you are experiencing, and breathe. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

Inquiry: What is my body saying?

Bring your attention to your body and notice if it is reacting to your opportunity to endure. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

Talk to Jesus

Imagine that you are leaning back in the safe and loving arms of Jesus as together you *consider this experience of endurance*. *(Pause)* Are you learning something about hurt pride or self-hate? We often experience hurt pride and self-hate when an aspect of our Idol's search for glory is threatened or lost. Observe and breathe. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

Heal

For thousands of years, human beings have felt strong feelings when they have had to endure a trial or difficulty. You are not alone in your experience. When your feelings signal you through the body, you can focus on your body and your breath rather than reacting and getting caught up in stories and judgments. Breathe, and help your body process with a long exhaling breath. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

Pause. Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the integration?")

1:28 ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

Thank You for this time together to train and to heal. Hold us in the power of this new understanding as You guide us to our glory and to the truth. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to reorient our lives for a more effective flow and to flourish in our connection with our True Self, with the Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about this meeting?")

1:29 ANNOUNCEMENTS

Remember to finish off your tap by repeating the first series of the **Tapping Protocol**.

The KF book study, *Honor, Patronage, Kinship, and Purity* (HPKP), by Dr. David deSilva begins soon. This study has helped many KF members explore the integrity of their own Christian beliefs in the context of first century values and culture.

¹ Luke 2:19.

² Karen Horney, *Neurosis and Human Growth* (New York: Norton, 1991).

³ [wikipedia.org/wiki/Brother_Lawrence](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Brother_Lawrence).

⁴ Mark 2:17.

⁵ Zindel Segal, J. Mark G. Williams, and John D. Teasdale, *Mindfulness-Based Cognitive Therapy for Depression* (New York: Guilford Press, 2013), 208. Adapted for Karis Fellowships by Nancy Diven.

⁶ *Breathe on Me, Breath of God* by Edwin Hatch (1835–1889), www.youtube.com/watch?v=M5keJHZdWYM.

⁷ Dr. Roger Callahan, "TFT Stress Buster Tapping Class-Learn to Use TFT Tapping," Callahan Techniques, accessed April 24, 2016, www.rogercallahan.com/learn-to-tap.php. Adapted for Karis Fellowships by Nancy Diven.

⁸ Phil 2:12.

⁹ Gal. 5:22–23.

¹⁰ Psalm 139:23–24 (Nancy's translation).

¹¹ "Robert Louis Stevenson Quotes," *Goodreads*, accessed April 24, 2016, www.goodreads.com/author/quotes/854076.Robert_Louis_Stevenson.

¹² M. Scott Peck, *The Road Less Traveled: A New Psychology of Love, Traditional Values, and Spiritual Growth* (New York: Touchstone, 1978), 15.